

[Home](#) > [Security Audit](#)

160 Cybersecurity Statistics 2026 [Updated]

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Summarize with:

(read in < 1 min)



ChatGPT



perplexity

On this page

Forecasts for Cybersecurity in 2026

Headliners for Cybersecurity in 2023

Popular Cybersecurity Trends in 2026

What are the most common IoT targets?

Which are the most commonly targeted Industri...

Cybersecurity statistics indicate that there are 2,200 cyber attacks per day, with a cyber attack happening every 39 seconds on average. In the US, a data breach costs an average of \$9.44M, and cybercrime is predicted to cost \$8 trillion by 2023.

The cybersecurity landscape is continuously evolving. And now with COVID-19, remote work, and [increasing cyber crimes](#) in the picture, maintaining fool-proof security is becoming harder and harder.

To give you a better view of what's happening with cybersecurity, we curated a list of 160 cybersecurity stats for 2026.

Forecasts for Cybersecurity in 2026

Did you know a cyberattack happens every 39 seconds? That's less time than it takes to order takeout. To put this in perspective, cybercrime is estimated to have cost the world USD 9.5 trillion in [2024](#).

DID YOU KNOW A CYBERATTACK HAPPENS EVERY 39 SECONDS?

This staggering amount underscores the imminent need for cybersecurity to be treated as a global priority. Moreover, with the explosion of generative AI (besides ChatGPT as well!), the current 2200 daily attacks are expected to not only multiply manifold but become far more individualized.

Despite the new technology, ransomware will possibly continue to dominate cybercrime in 2026. In fact, according to Statista, it was the leading motive for more than 72% of cybersecurity incidents in 2023.

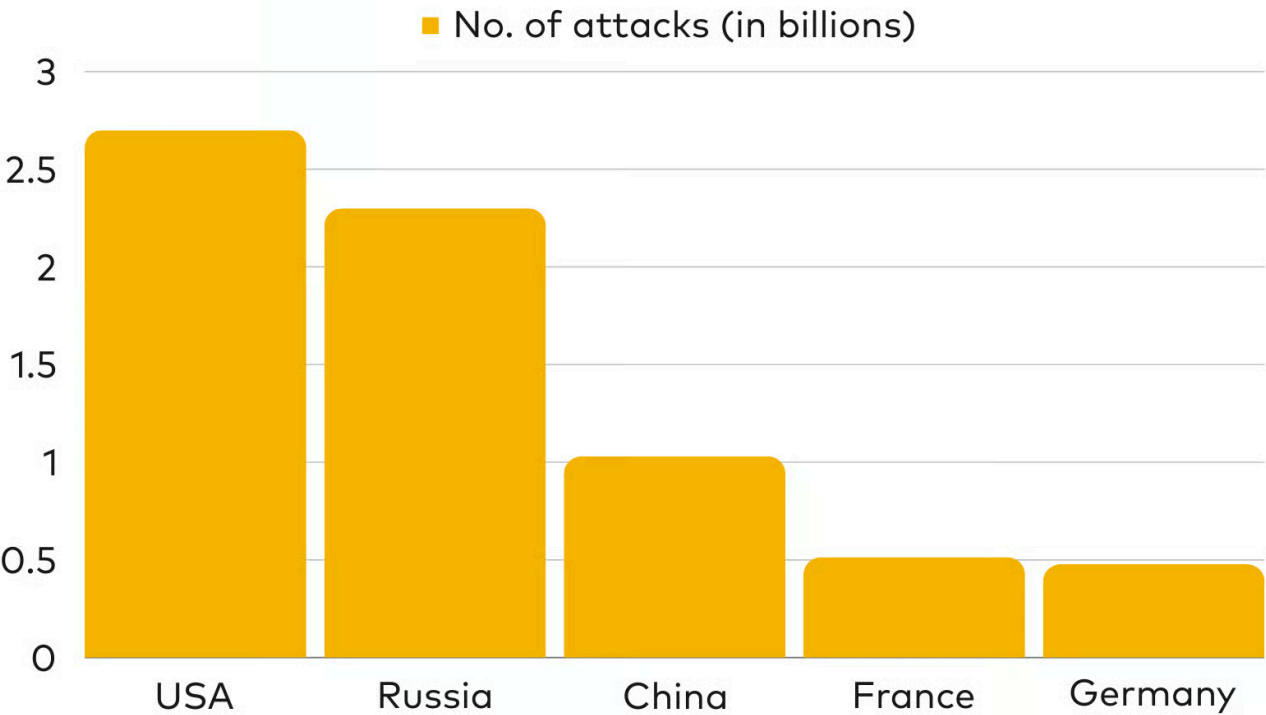
Moreover, even with the widespread impact, small and medium-sized businesses (SMBs) seem to be the new bullseye, as documented by [61%](#) of SMBs that were hit in 2023. As such, the expected growth of the global cybersecurity market to [\\$266.2 billion](#) by 2027 hardly comes as a surprise.

As such, with the alarming 8.9% CAGR of the cybersecurity industry, Gartner predicts that [50%](#) of C-suite leaders will have cybersecurity risk-related performance

requirements embedded in their contracts by 2026.

Top 5 Countries by Cybercrime Density

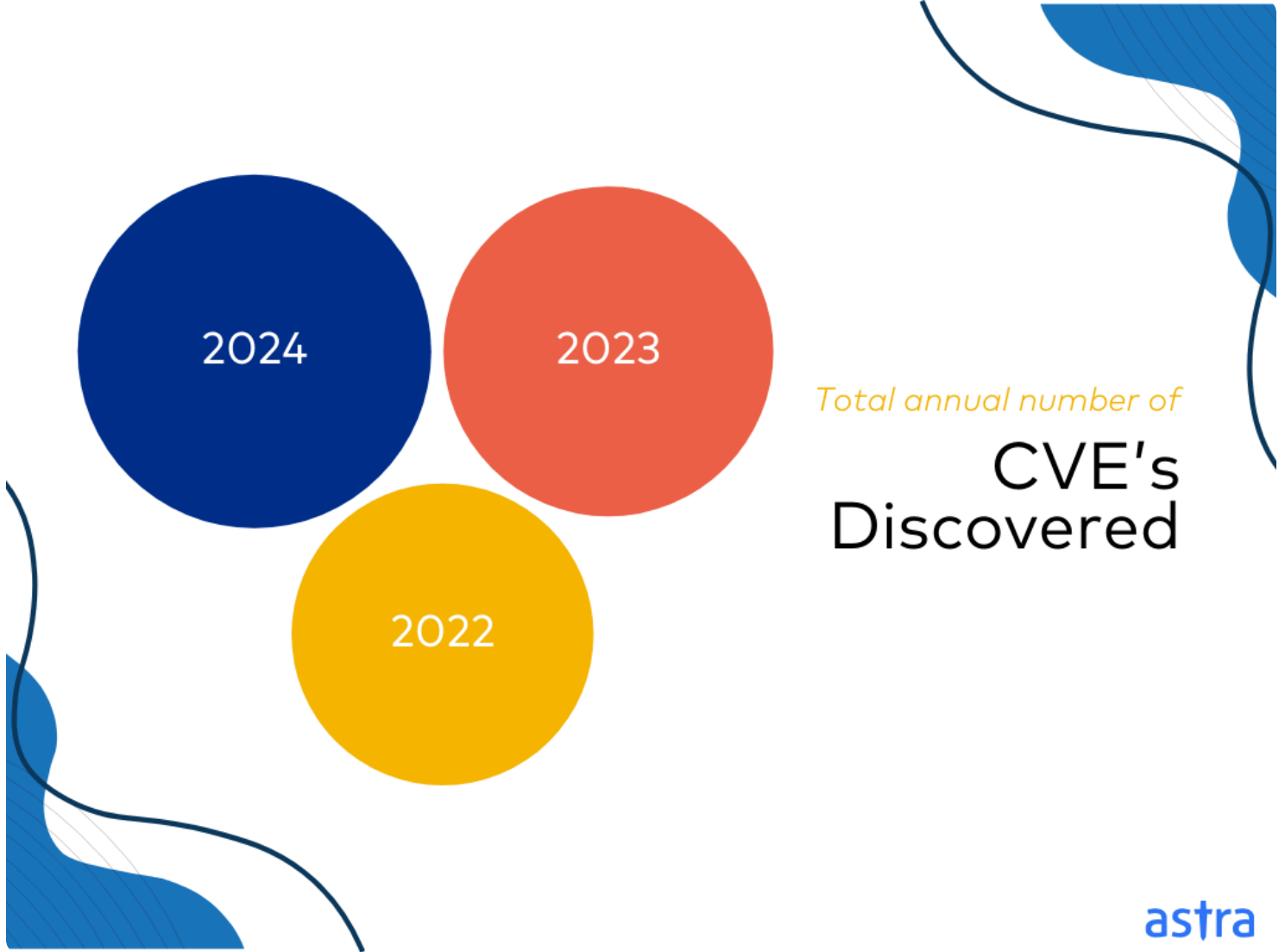
MOST ATTACKED COUNTRIES (SINCE 2004)



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Headliners for Cybersecurity in 2023

At the time of writing, [28778](#) new vulnerabilities have been discovered in 2023 alone, dwarfing 2022's total vulnerabilities by nearly [3700+](#). In fact, at the current rate of 14.8%, 2025 will have 33K+ CVEs.



Conversely, recent research by the World Economic Forum reveals a striking lack of confidence among organizations. Only [4% of organizations](#) are confident in their assurance of security to “users of connected devices and related technologies are protected against cyberattacks.”

This, unfortunately, indicates that most organizations (federal and private) have adopted a reactive rather than proactive approach to cybersecurity, i.e., they place damage control campaigns on a higher priority than preventative vigilance.

Simply put, Fortra’s reactive stance allowed hackers to exploit a [zero-day vulnerability](#), triggering a domino effect that affected over 130 companies. In contrast, Google’s proactive measures successfully defended against a massive DDoS attack, handling over [398 million requests](#) per second.

Adding to the bad news, [IBM’s 2023 report](#) indicates the average cost of a corporate data breach in 2023 stood at \$4.45 million. However, supply chain attacks can far

exceed such a cost, especially in the case of key APIs.

The infamous [MOVEit Supply Chain Attack](#) in June provided ample proof, as it compromised more than 620 organizations, including major companies such as the BBC and British Airways.

By the same token, [Gartner](#) predicts that over the next two years, 45% of global organizations will be impacted in some way by a supply chain attack. The takeaway: your organization is only as strong as its weakest link.

The bad news doesn't end there. The same [IBM report](#) also found that 82% of breaches involved cloud-based data, with ransomware being the primary threat. More frighteningly, even with blockchain safeguards, hackers got away with more than \$2 billion in cryptocurrencies in 2023.

However, that would still just be some nominal pocket change in the burgeoning [\\$8 trillion](#) cybercrime economy of 2023. To put this in perspective, the world lost \$255,000 every second this year to cyberattacks.

Let's take a look at some of the emerging trends in 2023.

Popular Cybersecurity Trends in 2026

As the threat landscape evolves with new threat vectors and novel methodologies and techniques, AIML, as well as intricate social engineering tactics, emerged as new favourites in 2023. Let's take a deeper dive into some of the popular cybersecurity, or rather cybercrime, trends of 2026:

Malware

Key Takeaways

- According to Parachute, threat actors deployed an average of [11.5 attacks per minute](#), including 1.7 novel malware samples per minute in 2023.
- 92% of malware was delivered via email.

- Quoting [IBM](#), “The share of breaches caused by ransomware grew 41% in the last year and took 49 days longer than average to identify and contain.”

In layman’s language, malware is malicious software designed to disrupt, damage, or gain unauthorized access to computer systems. Some of the most popular variants include viruses, worms, and ransomware, among others.

Although it has dominated the cyberattacks billboard for several years, along with global summits—from COP28 to Davos—the existing strategies continue to fail. This is due to two major reasons: the growing sophistication of the attacks thanks to genAI and the lack of cohesive management tools.

Don’t believe us? In the first half of 2022, [2.8 billion malware attacks](#) occurred, and that’s not even counting the [5,520,908 mobile malware, adware, and riskware attacks that were blocked in Q2 2022](#).

Moreover, the first half of 2022 saw a [massive 976.7% increase](#) in Emotet detections compared to the first half of 2021. Iran is the country most impacted by mobile malware attacks, and the VBA Trojan was the most [common malware variant in 2022](#).

How can you protect yourself from malware attacks?

- Use security software to detect and remove malicious programs.
- Leverage MFA and strong passwords to make it harder for attackers to access your device or accounts.
- Use up-to-date software, as older versions often have vulnerabilities.
- Never click on links from unknown sources as this is a common way for attackers to spread malware.

Ransomware

Key Takeaways

- The average ransom in 2023 was [\\$1.54 million](#), which is almost double the 2022 figure of \$812,380

- As of 2023, over [72%](#) of businesses worldwide were affected by ransomware attacks.
- **IBM reports that it takes an [average of 49 days](#) to identify a ransomware attack,** leaving businesses and organizations vulnerable for an extended period.

Ransomware simply refers to malware deployed to encrypt a victim's files. Attackers offer the company the decryption key against a hefty payment, usually in cryptocurrency. Thus, they exploit digital vulnerabilities to extort individuals and entities for financial gain.

In fact, since 2018, more than half of the total survey [respondents](#) each year have stated that their organizations had been victimized by ransomware.

Moreover, no one is safe from such attacks, not even established governments. [Austria was the most affected country](#) by ransomware attacks, while [Costa Rica's government](#) was the victim of the biggest attack in history, as reported by Cyber Management Alliance.

Ransomware-as-a-service (RaaS) is also a growing concern, with 67 active RaaS reported in the first six months of this year alone.

How can you protect yourself from ransomware attacks?

- Never use outdated software.
- Never click unsafe links.
- Never insert a USB that you don't own.
- Use VPNs on public networks.

DDoS Attacks

Key Takeaways

- According to Netscout, there were almost [7.9 million](#) DDoS attacks, approximately 44,000 attacks per day in the first half of 2023 alone.
- DDoS-Attack-as-a-Service is being advertised on the dark web for [\\$20 per day](#) to \$10,000 per month.

- [13 DDoS-for-hire marketplaces](#) were shut down in 2023 by the Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI).

DDoS or Distributed Denial of Service attacks are often mounted as a decoy to distract the owners of the targeted website while the hacker tries to mount a second, more exploitative attack.

Cloudflare has observed a significant increase in HTTP DDoS attacks, which rose by [111%](#) year-over-year. The gaming and gambling industries were the most targeted by L3/4 DDoS attacks, highlighting their vulnerability to such attacks.

Moreover, according to G2, every minute of downtime during a DDoS attack costs an average business anywhere from [\\$22,000](#) to \$1,20,000 for SMEs. Meanwhile, hackers can rent online resources to launch attacks for as little as \$5 per hour.

How can you protect yourself from DDoS attacks?

- Choose a DDoS mitigation service.
- Create a secure network infrastructure.
- Monitor your website traffic.
- Use Web Application Firewalls (WAF).

Social Engineering Attacks

Key Takeaways

- [Approximately 98%](#) of cyberattacks involve social engineering tactics, which often employ tricks or manipulation.
- According to Verizon's 2023 Report, [10% of security incidents](#) and 17% of data breaches were caused by social engineering.
- The average organization is targeted by more than [700 social engineering attacks](#) annually.

In layman's terms, social engineering refers to the various techniques of manipulation, influence, or deceit an attacker uses to gain unauthorized access to systems, data, and information. Phishing is the most popular social engineering attack.

[75% of security professionals](#) consider social engineering the “most dangerous” threat. These concerns are not unfounded, as evidenced by the 2,773 social engineering incidents reported in the recent Verizon study.

The severity of the threat is further highlighted by a high-profile case in which a hacker employed a social engineering attack to gain access to Twilio’s internal systems and the data of 125 customers.

How can you protect yourself from social engineering attacks?

- Use a secure Web Application Firewall (WAF).
- Enable MFA across all accounts.
- Set high-level spam filters.
- Conduct a pentest to detect vulnerabilities.

Phishing

Key Takeaways

- Phishing was the most common form of cybercrime, with approximately [3.4 billion](#) malicious emails sent every day.
- BEC-based phishing attacks increased from 1.6 attacks per 1,000 mailboxes in the latter half of 2022 to [2.5 attacks](#) over the first half of 2023.
- In 2023, IBM reported that phishing cost \$4.9 million per attack.

In simplest terms, phishing refers to the cluster of cybercrime techniques through which attackers deceive individuals into divulging sensitive information by impersonating legitimate entities. Common types include vishing, spear phishing, and smishing.

To put this in perspective, in November 2022 alone, [Google blocked over 231 billion spam](#) and phishing emails, highlighting the scale of the problem. In fact, according to Security Magazine, a total of [255 million](#) phishing attacks occurred over the last six months.

However, Business Email Compromise attacks are the most common type of phishing attack. In this case, attackers compromise or impersonate official email accounts to

deceive individuals within a business.

In 2022, a staggering [34% of all attacks](#) were launched as Business Email Compromise (BEC) attacks, according to Arctic Wolf. To make matters worse, a shocking [80% of organizations that fell victim to BEC attacks](#) didn't have a Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) solution in place.

How can you protect yourself from phishing attacks?

- Use a password manager like LastPass.
- Don't open emails that look spammy.
- Purchase antivirus software.
- Enable Multi-factor Authentication (MFA).
- Train your team to identify unsafe emails.

IoT Attacks

Key Takeaways

- A recent survey by [Tech Jury](#) suggests that 127 new IoT devices are connected to the internet every second.
- IoT malware attacks increased by 37% globally in 2023, resulting in more than [77.9 million](#) attacks in the first half itself.
- According to [Market Watch](#), the IOT security market is expected to grow to 13.36 billion by 2028.

With more than [15 billion IoT devices](#) and operational technology units present in the world, IoT security has emerged as an alarming issue in the past couple of years.

In the first six months of 2022 alone, a staggering [1.51 billion IoT breaches](#) were reported, highlighting the scale of the challenge faced by organizations. Compounding the issue, 51% of IT teams are unaware of the types of devices connected to their networks.

This indicates a lack of visibility and control over potential vulnerabilities. Moreover, the shortage of skilled personnel worsens data security concerns for most IoT companies.

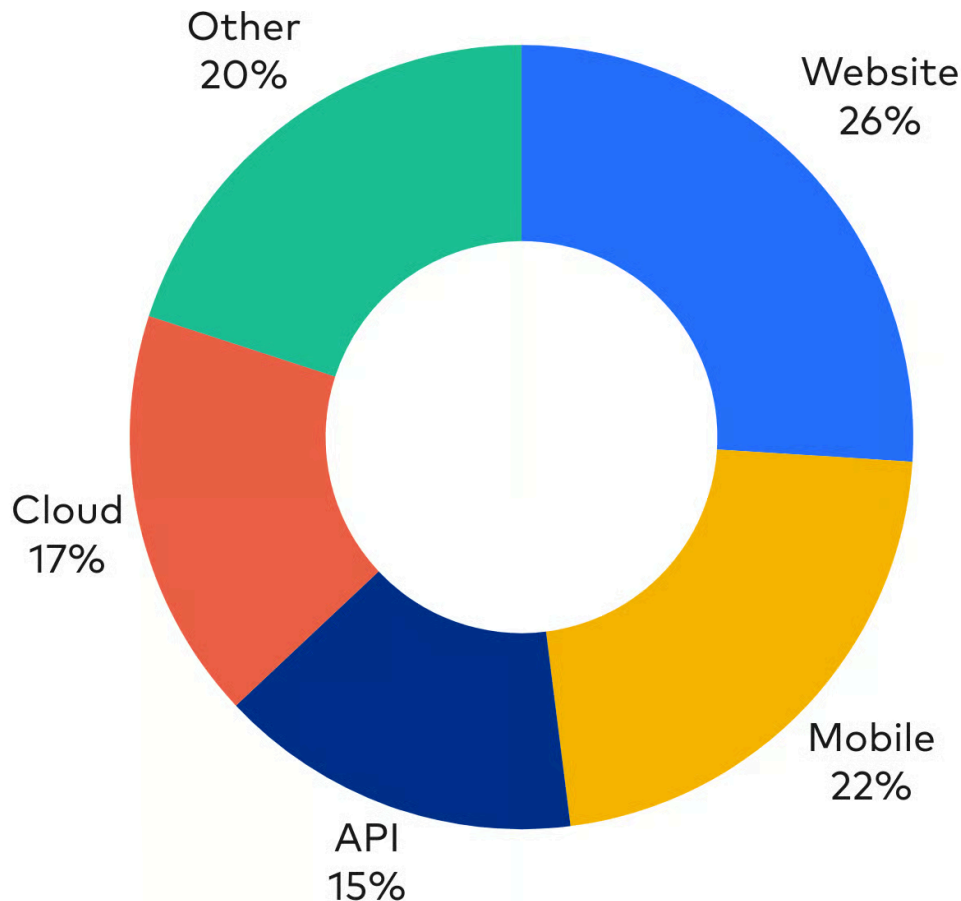
How can you protect yourself from IoT attacks?

- Update firmware and stay up-to-date.
- Use Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA).
- Encrypt your devices properly.
- Connect IoT devices using secure Wi-Fi.

What are the most common IoT targets?

As discussed earlier, the IoT network is made up of interconnected physical objects that communicate and share data with other devices and systems through the Internet. Common vulnerabilities include website security, mobile security, APIs, and cloud security, as discussed below:

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CVE'S DISCOVERED

Website Security

Key Takeaways

- Web application attacks contribute to [26% of breaches](#), ranking as the second most prevalent attack pattern.
- On average, a website experiences 94 attacks daily and is visited by bots approximately 2,608 times a week.
- Moreover, [17% of all cyber attacks](#) target vulnerabilities in [web applications](#).

The biggest danger with web app attacks is that attackers can not only gain unauthorized access and control to your data but also weaponize the same to promote cyber attacks in your name.

In fact, the situation has deteriorated such that [4.1 million](#) websites contain malware at any given time. E-commerce websites are particularly vulnerable, with [75%](#) of fraud and data theft involving them, as reported by GM Security.

Most of these vulnerabilities leverage WordPress plugins, with [97%](#) of security breaches exploiting them. Despite this, 22% of WordPress administrators spend less than an hour per month on security.

To put this into perspective, in a recent high-profile incident, over 280,000 WordPress sites were attacked using the WP Gateway plugin's zero-day vulnerability, according to [The Hacker News](#).

How can you protect your website from cyberattacks?

- Use a strong firewall and intrusion detection to monitor and filter traffic.
- Keep all website software up-to-date for security patches.
- Implement SSL encryption for secure data transmission.
- Run regular website [vulnerability scans](#) and conduct [pentests](#).
- Leverage MFA & password managers.

Mobile Application Security

Key Takeaways

- [80% of phishing attacks](#) targeted or functioned on mobile devices.

- [82%](#) of Android devices were vulnerable to at least one of 25 vulnerabilities in the Android operating system.
- The global mobile security market is expected to reach [\\$14.82 billion](#) by 2028.

The increasing dependence and adoption of smartphones have triggered a wave of concern. This is especially concerning since [75% of phishing sites](#) are specifically designed for mobile devices, according to Zimperium.

Moreover, smartphone users are 6-10 times more susceptible to SMS phishing than email attacks. Although mobile app stores are taking measures to combat this, the losses are still mounting.

[Google](#) and Apple have collectively blocked 1.2 million suspicious applications, while Apple has intervened and blocked fraudulent transactions in the ballpark of [\\$2 million](#). Nonetheless, all the blame doesn't lie with providers.

User behavior also plays a role in mobile security breaches, with [44% of companies](#) that suffered a mobile security breach attributing it to user behavior, according to Verizon.

How can you protect your mobile app from cyberattacks?

- Conduct routine security audits to identify and fix vulnerabilities.
- Implement strong encryption for data in transit and at rest.
- Use robust authentication and authorization mechanisms.

API Security

Key Takeaways

- According to a recent report, [94%](#) of survey respondents had some security issues with their production APIs over the past year.
- The number of unique API attacks has increased by [60%](#) year over year from 2022 to 2023.
- Despite the above, only [53% of respondents](#) listed security as their top priority.

APIs account for 91% of all [web traffic](#), making them a prime target for attackers.

Malicious API traffic increased by [681% in 2022](#), according to Salt Labs, and there has been a 286% increase in API threats quarter over quarter.

According to a report by VentureBeat, [41% of organizations](#) experienced an API security incident in the last 12 months, with 63% of those incidents resulting in a data breach or loss.

Despite rising threats, numerous organizations lack adequate API security measures. The above report by Salt Labs also reveals that 34% lack an API security strategy, with 62% slowing new application rollout due to security concerns.

How can you protect your API & endpoints from cyberattacks?

- Ensure that only authorized users have access to your API and limit their privileges.
- Validate all user input to prevent injection attacks.
- Implement rate limiting to prevent malicious actors from overwhelming your API with requests and causing denial of service (DoS) attacks.
- Encrypt all sensitive data transmitted between clients and servers.
- Continuously test and monitor your API for vulnerabilities.

Cloud Security

Key Takeaways

- [52% of malware](#) can use USB drives to bypass network security
- According to IBM's Data Breach report, more than [45% of data breaches](#) are cloud-based.
- As such, the cloud security market is expected to grow from \$40.7 billion in 2023 to [\\$62.9 billion](#) by 2028.

Thales Group reports that [66% of organizations](#) store 21%-60% of their sensitive data in the cloud. As such, with rising adoption, security concerns have also become prevalent.

In fact, the same report reveals that 51% of IT professionals perceive that managing privacy and security has become more complex. Protecting data in multi-cloud environments is even more challenging, with [57% of organizations](#) struggling to do so, according to Checkpoint.

According to the IBM report, cloud misconfigurations account for [15% of initial attack vectors](#) in security breaches. Meanwhile, 51% of organizations cite phishing as their primary concern in cloud security.

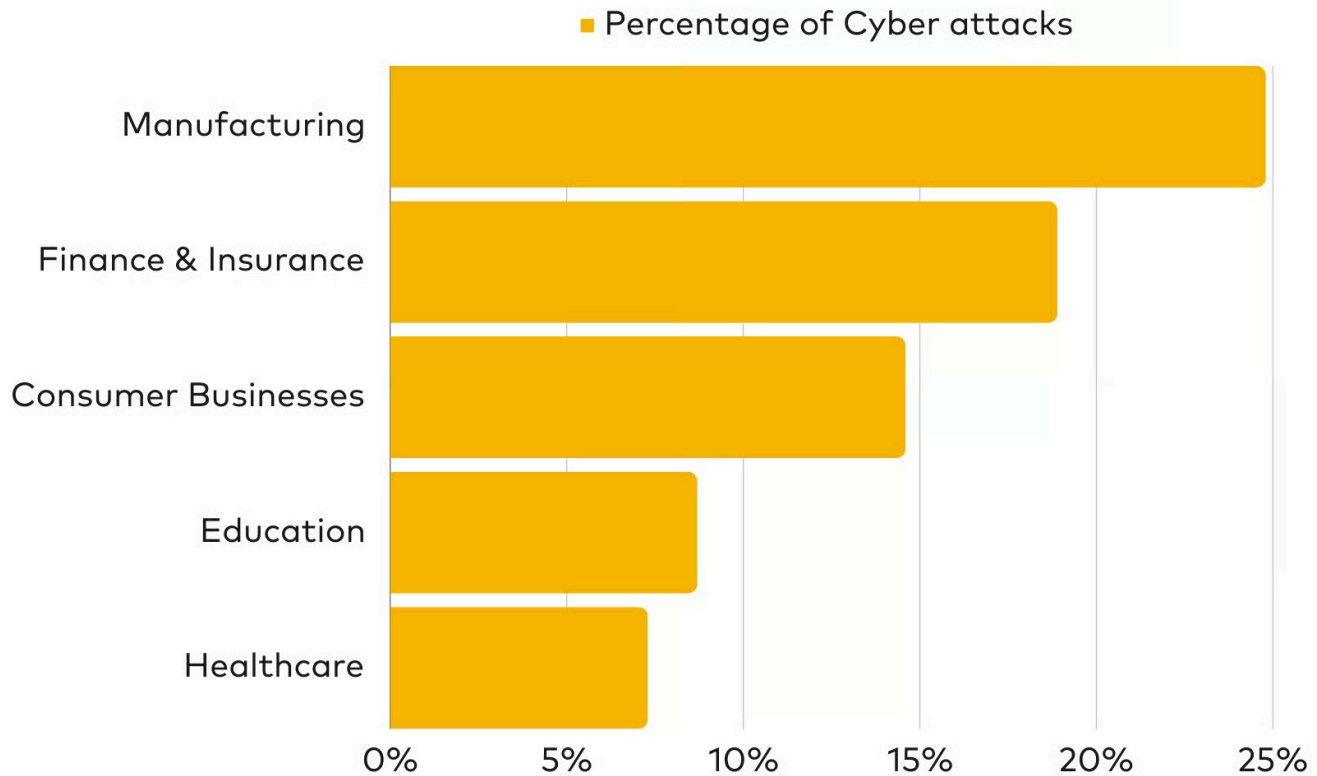
Lastly, with compliance, 56% of organizations struggle to find and hire skilled cloud security professionals, making cloud security seem like an improbable goal.

How can you protect your cloud infrastructure from cyberattacks?

- Restrict access based on the principle of least privilege.
- Prioritize container security practices.
- Implement regular data backups and a solid disaster recovery plan.
- Train employees on security best practices.
- [Conduct regular cloud pentests](#) to identify misconfigurations.

Which are the most commonly targeted Industries?

MOST ATTACKED INDUSTRIES



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Manufacturing

Key Takeaways

- Ransomware struck [56% of manufacturing](#) companies surveyed between January and March 2023.
- [85%](#) of all attacks were weaponized phishing in 2023.
- According to Gartner, 63% of respondents reported that their organization has experienced a supply chain attack in the past year

Accounting for nearly 25% of all cyberattacks, the increasing adoption of robotics, IoT (Internet of Things) technology, and automation by the manufacturing industry has painted a bullseye for cybercriminals.

Out of the victims of ransomware, more than [one-third of manufacturers](#) paid the ransom in an attempt to get their data back. However, only 1 in 4 companies were able to thwart

the attacks before their data was fully encrypted.

Moreover, the adoption of AIML not only in storage but also in the operations of digital assets on a daily basis has increased the attack surface even more.

How can you protect your manufacturing firm from cyberattacks?

- Implement access controls and limit privileges for employees.
- Employ intrusion detection and prevention systems.
- Regularly update and patch industrial control systems to address vulnerabilities.

Finance & Insurance

Key Takeaways

- [17.5 million](#) credit card numbers were sold on the black market.
- Hackers registered over [42,000 imposter domains](#) to execute a large-scale phishing attack in 2023.
- In Q1 2023, phishing attacks disproportionately targeted the finance sector, constituting a substantial [23.6%](#) of total cyber incidents.

With a rise in politically motivated attacks, the financial sector has become a favored target. Losses incurred by financial organizations amounted to approximately \$5.9 million per incident in 2023.

According to Security Boulevard, [80% of the organizations](#) encountered at least one breach related to weak authentication.

The impacts of these cyberattacks are massive, as evident from the Transit Finance incident, where [\\$29 million](#) was stolen by a hacker. Additionally, [71 percent of organizations](#) were victims of payment fraud attacks or attempts.

How can you protect your financial firm from cyberattacks?

- Strengthen cybersecurity with encryption and regular updates.
- Develop an agile incident response plan.
- Leverage advanced threat detection for real-time monitoring.

Consumer Businesses

Key Takeaways

- In retail, the average cost of a data breach in 2022 was [\\$3.28 million](#).
- 50% of retail cyberattack victims were extorted, and 25% had their credentials harvested.
- More than [20% of customers](#) stop purchasing from companies that have been hacked.

Living in a post-pandemic world with remote operational models, the digitization trend has become a necessity for E-commerce businesses. [68% of companies](#) experienced a targeted attack on their networks and suffered data loss as a direct result.

[63%](#) of such data breaches come from exploiting internal weak points in a company's customer and vendor network. Moreover, according to a recent research by BDO, [34% of retailers](#) said that cyber attacks or privacy breaches were their most serious digital threat

As such, in 2023, E-commerce fraud cost the retail sector more than [\\$48 billion](#) globally.

How can you protect your consumer business from cyberattacks?

- Use secure and compliant payment processing solutions.
- Regularly analyze network activity for anomalies and potential security threats.
- Develop and test a clear incident response plan to efficiently handle breaches.

Education

Key Takeaways

- In 2023, over [700,000 threats](#) were detected between April and June alone.
- In 2023, the [rate of ransomware attacks](#) in the education sector was more than double at 44% of the rate reported in 2021.
- The average cost of data recovery dropped from \$1.42 million in 2022 to about \$1 million in 2023.

The education sector, with its extensive sensitive data and limited cybersecurity resources, has been an appealing target for cybercriminals for the past few years. With an average of almost [2,000 attacks per organization](#) reported weekly in 2022, the education industry has had it rough.

To put the above in perspective, of the above attacks, [36%](#) were attributed to compromised credentials and 29% to exploited vulnerabilities, all of which could have been prevented by simple MFA.

According to IBM, the average cost of a data breach in the higher education and training sector was [\\$3.7 million](#) in 2023, down from \$3.9 million in 2022.

How can you protect your educational organization from cyberattacks?

- Strengthen cybersecurity with regular audits and updates.
- Establish robust backup systems for quick recovery.
- Utilize endpoint protection for device security.

Healthcare

Key Takeaways

- According to [the U.S. government's OCR](#), healthcare firms reported 145 data breaches in the first quarter of 2023 alone.
- Phishing attacks were used in [45% of all healthcare data breaches](#) in 2023.
- Ransomware attacks, in particular, have been a major threat to [healthcare organizations](#), with [707 attacks](#) in 2023.

Compared to the previous year, the number of cybersecurity breaches has increased; however, the loss from each incident has risen significantly.

Simply put, the number of individuals affected by such breaches jumped from 31 million in the second half of 2022 to a new record of 40 million in 2023. Furthermore, third-party data breaches have also had severe consequences.

More than 119 pediatric practices and [2.2 million patients](#) were impacted by a single incident. Furthermore, [New York-Presbyterian \(NYP\) Hospital](#) reported a data breach

that affected approximately 12,000 people in September 2022.

Similarly, Aveanna Healthcare was hit with several phishing-related data breaches, for which they agreed to pay [\\$425,000 in settlements](#).

How can you protect your healthcare business from cyberattacks?

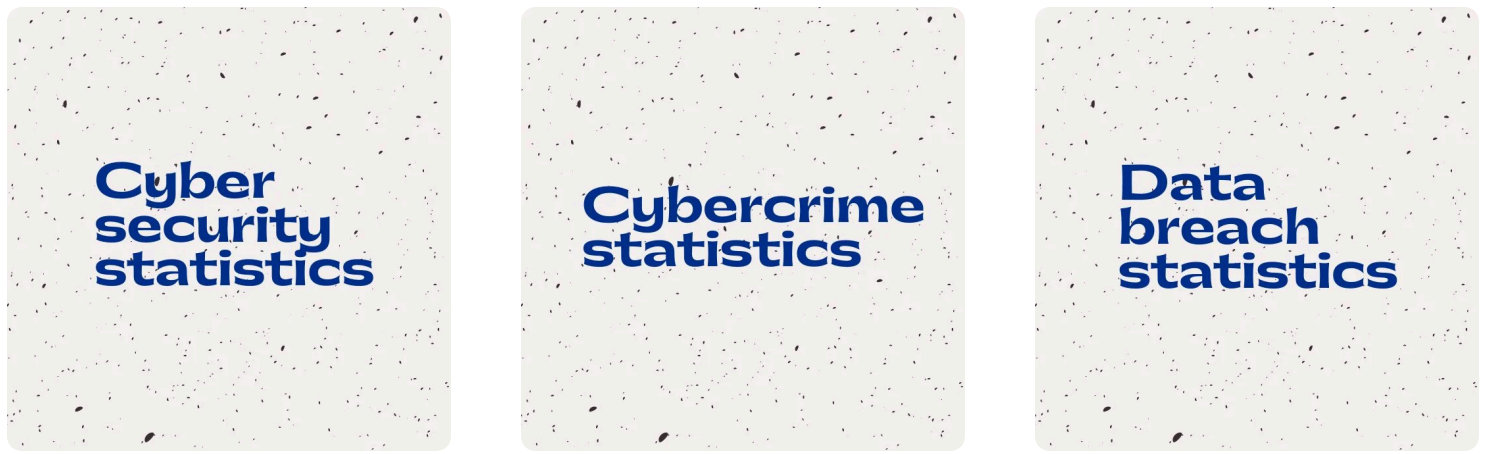
- Restrict access to sensitive data through stringent user authentication and authorization measures.
- Keep healthcare systems and software up to date.
- Educate healthcare personnel on recognizing and mitigating cyber threats.

Final Thoughts

With the cybersecurity landscape changing ever so constantly, knowing the figures and facts related to it, and its risks like phishing, ransomware, and other scams can give a deep insight.

The proactive adoption of preventive measures, awareness of emerging trends, and industry-specific safeguards are crucial for robust cybersecurity defenses in 2026.

With this extensive compilation of 160 cybersecurity statistics for 2026 we aim to provide valuable insights into emerging trends, attack vectors, and the industries most targeted. Stay informed, stay secure.



**Cyber
security
statistics**

**Cybercrime
statistics**

**Data
breach
statistics**

**Healthcare
Data
breach
statistics**

**Phishing
attack
statistics**

**Ransomware
attack
statistics**

**Small
business
cyber
attack
statistics**

**3rd party
data breach
statistics**

**Cyber
insurance
statistics**

FAQs

How many cyber attacks happen per year?

It is estimated that 2023 will face around 33 billion account breaches. Cyber attacks 8,00,000 have been recorded in total, and on average, there is a hacker attack every 39 seconds.

Cyber attacks on banks statistics?

20 million banking cyberattacks have been found and blocked according to Kaspersky. 79% of IT professionals believe the banking sector is a soft target for darknet operators.

How many cyber attacks happen per day?

Around 2328 cyber crimes are thought to occur each day. Over the last 21 years from 2001 to 2021, cyber crime has claimed at least 6.5 million victims with an estimated loss of nearly \$26 billion over the same period.



This post is **part of a series on Cybersecurity**. You can also check out other articles below.

- Chapter 1: [160 Cybersecurity Statistics 2026 \[Updated\]](#)
- Chapter 2: [Top Cybersecurity Trends Shaping 2026](#)
- Chapter 3: [How Cybersecurity Audits Can Help Organizations Being Secure?](#)
- Chapter 4: [How to Respond to a Cybersecurity Breach?](#)
- Chapter 5: [6 Practical Cyber Security Tips for Startups on a Budget](#)
- Chapter 6: [Top 10 Cyber Security Audit Companies](#)
- Chapter 7: [Top 9 Cyber Security Assessment Companies](#)
- Chapter 8: [What Is a Cyber Security Report?](#)
- Chapter 9: [AI in Cybersecurity: Benefits and Challenges](#)
- Chapter 10: [How to Build a Cyber Security Culture?](#)
- Chapter 11: [What is CTEM \(Continuous Threat Exposure Management\)?](#)

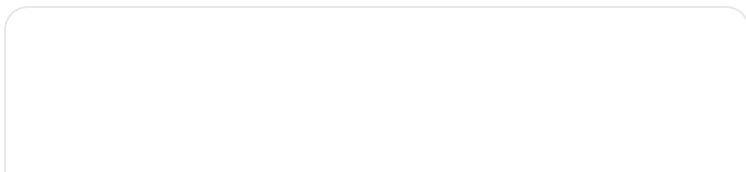
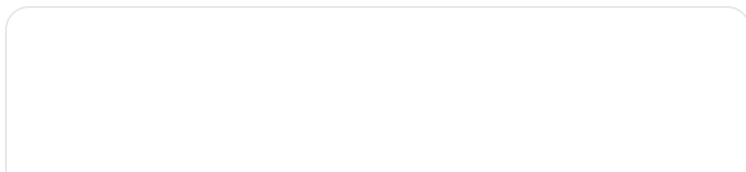


Sanskriti Jain

Sanskriti is a technical writer at Astra who believes in writing with purpose and for a purpose. When she is not busy exploring the world of cybersecurity, you will probably find her with her nose buried deep in a book or on the lookout for a perfectly brewed cup of coffee.



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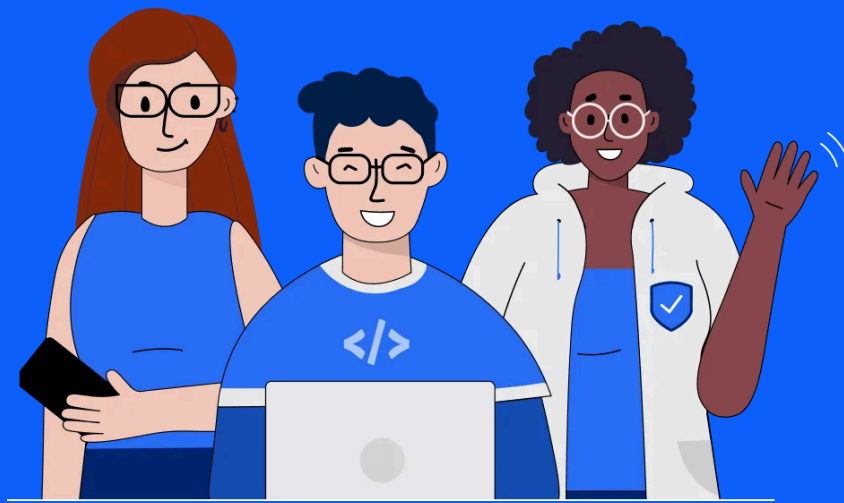
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